CONTRACTOR SUPPORT OF U.S. OPERATIONS IN THE USCENTCOM AREA OF RESPONSIBILITY

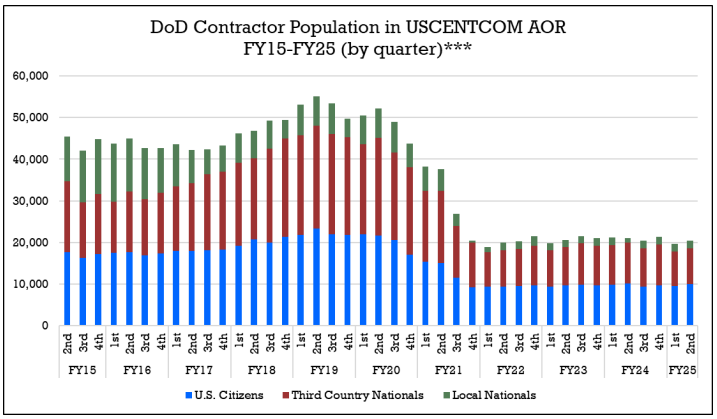
BACKGROUND: This report provides Department of Defense (DoD) contractor personnel numbers for 2nd quarter Fiscal Year 2025 (FY25) and the current status of efforts underway to improve management of contractors accompanying United States (U.S.) Forces. It includes data on DoD contractor personnel deployed in Iraq and Syria, Operation Inherent Resolve (OIR), and the U.S. Central Command (USCENTCOM) area of responsibility (AOR). The future of this report has been under review by the Department for several months. The Department has concluded that this will be the final report published. While these reporting activities provided an extremely valuable tool to visualize and manage the contractor personnel deployments in the CENTCOM AOR, focus must shift to include other regions and priorities.

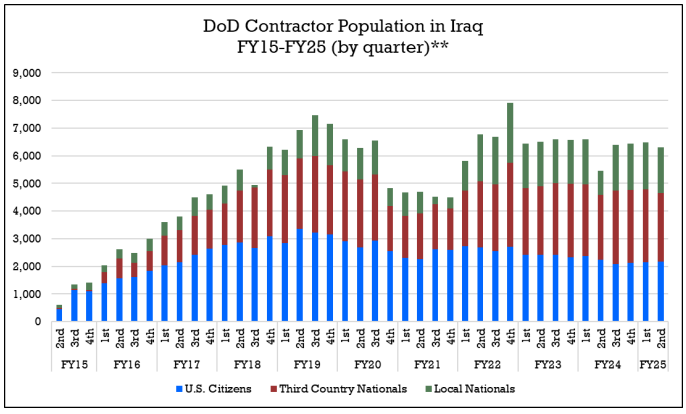
KEY POINTS: During 2nd quarter FY25, USCENTCOM reported approximately 20,356 contractor personnel supporting DoD in the USCENTCOM AOR, an increase of approximately 685 from the previous quarter.

DoD Contractor Personnel in the USCENTCOM AOR

	Total Contractors	U.S. Citizens	Third Country Nationals (TCN)	Local Nationals
Iraq and Syria	6,301	2,173	2,485	1,643
Other USCENTCOM Locations	14,055	7,813	6,159	83
USCENTCOM AOR	20,356	9,986	8,644	1,726

DoD Contractor Population Trends (FY15–FY25)*





* To maintain a 10-year quarterly view of contractor populations, the date range has been changed to reflect FY15-FY25 data.

** Information on the contractor population in Syria was incorporated starting 2nd quarter FY18.

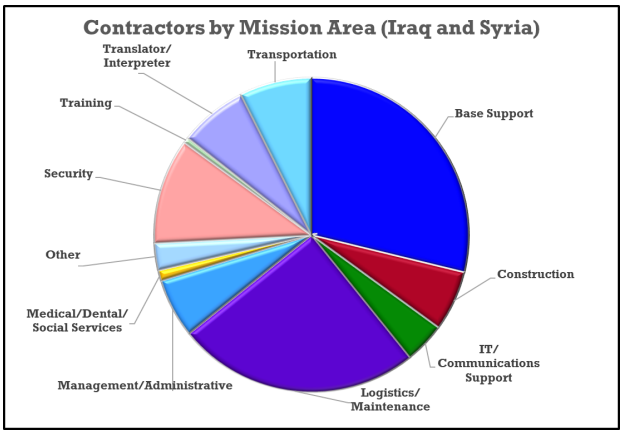
*** Information on the contractor population in Israel is included in the USCENTCOM AOR totals starting in 4th quarter FY21.

Prepared by: ODASD(Log) April 2025

OIR (Iraq and Syria) Summary

- The distribution of contractors in Iraq and Syria by mission category are:

Base Support	1,815	28.8%
Construction	391	6.2%
IT/Communications Support	265	4.2%
Logistics/Maintenance	1,575	25.0%
Management/Administrative	384	6.1%
Medical/Dental/Social Services	69	1.1%
Other	176	2.8%
Security	681	10.8%
Training	38	0.6%
Translator/Interpreter	441	7.0%
Transportation	466	7.4%
Total:	6,301	



  - Contractor Posture: Approximately 6,301 DoD contractors directly supported DoD-funded contracts in Iraq and Syria. This is a decrease of 2.7% from 1st quarter FY25.

- **USCENTCOM Operational Contract Support (OCS):**
  - **Combined Joint Task Force - Operation INHERENT RESOLVE (CJTF-OIR) Operational Contract Support Integration Cell (OCSIC)**:
    - This quarter, CJTF-OIR OCSIC supported an evolving mission in Syria. Commercial capabilities and locally procured force protection assets were used to open a key highway in Syria that significantly enhanced logistical capabilities within the combined joint operational area and facilitated the efficient movement of supplies and personnel between three separate bases.
    - Additionally, CJTF-OIR OCSIC achieved US Army Central's strategic objective of reducing non-tactical vehicle (NTV) procurement by 30% in FY25 by consolidating all NTV leasing requirements into a single package, eliminating multiple requirements packages and lease periods. Development of a comprehensive NTV common operating picture further enhanced visibility for future validation purposes.

IMPROVEMENTS TO MANAGEMENT AND OVERSIGHT OF DOD CONTRACTORS

- **Office of the Deputy Assistant Secretary of Defense for Logistics (ODASD(Log)):**
  - **OCS Governance and Oversight**. On February 26, 2025, the Performing the Duties of the DASD(Log) and the Principal Deputy Director for Logistics, Joint Staff-J4 (JS J4) co-chaired the 2nd quarter FY25 OCS Functional Capabilities Integration Board (FCIB) meeting. Key topics included an out brief by U.S. European Command (USEUCOM) on the recent Joint OCS Planning Event (JOPE), the first event of its kind, and a briefing from U.S. Special Operations Command (USSOCOM) on their efforts to further integrate, plan for, and exercise commercial support capabilities. The JS J4 also provided an update on efforts to improve contracting in Guam and Micronesia. In addition, the Board approved closure of two open DoD OCS Action Plan tasks. The next OCS FCIB meeting will be held on May 21, 2025.

- On February 25, 2025, the Governmental Accountability Office (GAO) published an update to its biennial High-Risk Report. The updated report removed OCS as a sub-area under DoD Contract Management. The publication of DoDI 3020.41, *Operational Contract Support Outside the Unites States*, in November 2024, was the Department's last condition to meet before removal.

- **OCS Joint Capability Improvement Working Group (CIWG) Update**. On January 23, 2025, ODASD(Log) CSO Directorate co-chaired the quarterly OCS CIWG with the JS J45 Operational Contract Support Division (OCSD). The CIWG reviewed two actions, one from the DoD OCS Action Plan (OCS integration in wargaming) and one initiated by the OCS FCIB principals (Defense Federal Acquisition Regulation Supplement updates). The CIWG recommended both actions proceed to the 2nd quarter FY25 OCS FCIB, where they were formally closed. The next OCS CIWG meeting is scheduled for April 17, 2025.

- **Defense Standards for Security Services:**

  - All DoD contracts for private security services require compliance with American National Standard Institute (ANSI) PSC.1-2012 (R2017), "Quality Management Standard for Private Security Company Operations" or International Organization for Standardization (ISO) 18788-2015 "Management Systems for Private Security Operations." All private security companies contracted by DoD at any tier are currently compliant with one or both of the existing standards and have achieved independent third-party certification.

  - The DoD continues to review timelines for companies to transition to the revised standard, ANSI/ASIS PSC.1-2022 "Management System for Private Security Company Operations—Requirements with Guidance."

  - A total of 94 private security companies from 31 different countries have achieved independent third-party certification to one or both standards. The decrease from the 4th quarter report is partially attributable to reporting changes from one of the certification bodies.

- **JS J45, OCSD:**

  - **Assessments and Reporting.** J45 OCSD conducted the Reporting Working Group meeting on January 8, 2025, kicking off the FY25 commercial assessments program. More than 40 representatives from the Combatant Commands (CCMDs), Services, and Combat Support Agencies participated.

  - **Individual Training.**

    - **Joint OCS Planning and Execution Course (JOPEC**). During 2nd quarter FY25, J45 OCSD trained 92 students through three JOPEC offerings, including one distance-learning course and two in-person courses, hosted by the U.S. Indo-Pacific Command (INDOPACOM) and the USSOCOM.

    - **Joint Knowledge Online (JKO).** On January 10, 2025, J45 OCSD launched the final two phases of the planned four-phase suite of OCS training, replacing the now-retired, Joint OCS Essentials for Commanders and Staff suite. All four phases are now available to students on the JKO platform:

- OCS I, *Leveraging Commercial Capabilities Across the Competition Continuum*. A total of 4,595 students have completed OCS I to date.
- OCS II, *OCS Fundamentals*. A total of 1,497 students have completed OCS II to date.
- OCS III, *Planning and Coordinating Responsibilities for Staffs*. A total of 29 students have completed OCS III to date.
- OCS IV, *Planning and Execution Responsibilities for OCS Practitioners*. A total of 20 students have completed OCS IV to date.

- **Joint Logistics Course (JLC), Army Sustainment University (ASU).** J45 OCSD delivered OCS instruction at three sessions of the JLC, on January 10, February 27, and March 20, 2025, respectively, to a total of 107 students.
- **Joint Engineer Operations Course (JEOC), U.S. Army Engineer School.** J45 OCSD delivered a presentation on leveraging commercial capabilities through OCS to 55 operational engineers attending the JEOC on February 26, 2025.
- **Facilitated Training on Joint OCS Planning and Integration, Navy Supply Corps Fleet Logistics Centers.** On February 10, 2025, J45 OCSD delivered a one-hour OCS training session focusing on OCS in the context of current operations for 27 Navy Supply Corps personnel.
- **Marine Corps War College (MCWAR), Marine Corps University.** On March 24, 2025, J45 OCSD delivered a one-hour training module to 25 MCWAR students focused on commercial support to operations and commercial capabilities in campaigning.
- **USEUCOM JOPE.** J45 OCSD facilitated the first-ever JOPE, which was held at NATO Support and Procurement Agency headquarters in Capellen, Luxembourg, January 27–31, 2025. The 66 participants advanced their understanding of commercial capabilities and requirements planning and integration in shared plans with NATO allies and the USEUCOM OCS planning community.

- **OCS in Exercises**. J45 OCSD co-facilitated a tabletop exercise on March 27, 2025, set in the Indo-Pacific theater designed to improve understanding of the roles for, and the limitations, of commercial entities during crisis and conflict. The exercise highlighted the benefits of bringing industry into operational planning as early as possible and explored what the Joint Force's commercial partners bring to the fight and their associated challenges.